

Intex B133Z-E2110

No business being a business laptop

The new B133Z-E2110 from Intex is a good looking light-weight laptop. With its brushed metal finish black body and silver outlines, this laptop scores some points in the looks department. Intex has kept the laptop light-weight and portable.

The glossy display stands tall at 13.3-inches, and reproduces some brilliant and vibrant visuals, which are visible from most angles. As far as input devices are concerned, this notebook has a small keyboard, and those with large fingers will have trouble using the function and scroll keys. The trackpad, however, is quite sensitive and a joy to work on. You don't even need to feel for the left-click button.

To make it portable and light weight, Intex includes a smaller 4-cell battery in this laptop, and this is only capable of running it for an

hour. This is terrible, because you would think that battery life is of the utmost importance in a business notebook.

In terms of configuration, the laptop features an Intel T5750 processor running at 2 GHz with 2 GB of DDR2 RAM. The laptop doesn't come with an installed OS, so if you're a Linux junkie, this is a good thing; terrible for Windows users, because you have to shell out extra for an OS — or maybe not!

In terms of performance, this system is rather slow and is good enough for basic office work such as word processing, presentations and Web browsing.

You can connect to the Net via WiFi, LAN and 3 USB ports to choose from if you want to hook up your USB data card.



Specifications

Intel T5750 processor, 2GB RAM, 160 GB HDD, 8X DVD RAM drive, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, 3 USB ports.

Contact: Intex Technologies Ltd.
Phone: 1800116789
E-mail: info@intextechnologies.com
Web site: www.intextechnologies.com
Price: Rs 37,900

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

The laptop performed badly in our tests, scoring just 2854 marks in PCMark 05, and a mere 373 in 3DMark 05.

We're very reluctant to recommend this laptop to business users, because of the pathetic battery life. The performance scores were understandable, and this laptop is good enough for everyday office tasks, but only if you keep it plugged in. This defeats the purpose of it being light and portable.

Creative VADO

Pocket sized video

Anybody who sees the Creative VADO for the very first time will confuse it with a portable media player. Don't. This sleek and stylish metallic silver body hides a portable video recorder. It allows you to capture videos easily and quickly.

To start with, the Creative VADO comprises of a non-auto focus camera, with which you can record videos at a resolution of 640 x 480. It features 2 GB of memory, and this is non-expandable, which is a serious turn-off. At its resolution, though, this translates to about 2 hours of video recording.

Just like any other cam-



recorder, the VADO also gives two options to record video, both at the same VGA resolution. When using High Quality mode, you can capture about 1 hour of video. In Standard Play mode you can get about two hours of video. Battery life is good, so you will run out of memory way before you run out of charge. Obviously, at VGA

resolutions, recorded videos look pixellated, and you can make out the difference between High Quality and Standard Play recording modes. The convenience of being able to pull something out of your pocket, start recording and then put it away just as easily.

The VADO allows recorded content to be transferred via USB, and you don't need to lug around cables, because it has a retractable connector. Using a bundled utility, uploading video to YouTube is as easy as pushing a button.

Overall, if you're not looking for great video quality, and want to shell out Rs 7,000 for convenience of point and record, the VADO will keep you happy.

Specifications

VGA resolution camera, 2GB onboard memory, Rechargeable battery, USB 2.0 compatible, Direct YouTube uploads.

Contact: Creative Technology Ltd
Phone: 9352034111
E-mail: nishant_mathur@ctl.creative.com
Web site: http://in.creative.com/
Price: Rs 6,999

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Kingston Data Traveler HyperX pen drive

Speed comes at a price

Flash memory-based drives are evolving at a fast pace. While the capacities have gone up considerably, data transfer speeds are also a lot better than before, in general.

Some of the very best drives come from memory manufacturers themselves, and Kingston's HyperX is one of them.

This drive gets its looks from the blue-black HyperX memory modules. It has an aluminium and rubber casing, and this gives it strength and a good grip-

ping surface. You're unlikely to drop it, but if you do, the sturdy build will ensure that your data stays safe. The connector is retractable, so just slide it out when you want to use it.

The drive we got for review had 8 GB of storage space; but it's the performance that interested us more. In HD Tach benchmark this drive showed an access time of 11.9 ms, while the read and write speeds stood tall at 29.6 and 19.8 MBps. In our data transfer tests, we were able to copy 1 GB of sequen-

tial data in under a minute. Assorted data (1 GB, 441 files) took about a minute and 46 seconds. We were shocked to find that CPU utilisation jumped when transferring.

Speed comes at a price though, and for this drive, it seems to be CPU utilisation and price. At Rs 11,000 for the 8 GB model, this drive is not cheap. You also have 2 and 4 GB versions for cheaper, but considering that you get a 16 GB Data Traveller from the same manufacturer for about one-third the price, this drive seems like a luxury. If you are rich, have an obsession with speed, and want to make every second of your super-fast paced life count, buy this drive. If not, you're



probably still looking at the price tag.

Specifications

8 GB Storage space, Windows Vista ready boost Enhanced, 5 year warranty, Dimensions: 2.76 x 0.88 x 0.44 in

Contact: Kingston Technology Company Inc.
Phone: 022-26592961
E-mail: trista_wang@kingston.com.tw
Web site: www.kingston.com/india
Price: 11,115

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Creative ZEN Mozaic

Mosaic Art

The first time you see the Creative ZEN Mozaic, it looks like a flatter and larger version of ZEN Stone plus — similar body and rounded corners. At closer inspection you can see the difference. The ZEN Mozaic has got a matte charcoal finish all over and gray and white accented keys that look great on it.

As far as support is concerned the ZEN mosaic supports majority audio formats, MP3 and WMA to name a few. Along with that it can also play video content on it as well, though you will definitely have to wait for hours to convert the video with the bundled utility. We wish there was support for newer video formats like MP4 and DivX on this PMP.

The ZEN Mozaic has a 1.4-inch colour display screen

having a resolution of 128 x 160 pixels. The display is vibrant and colourful, and is good enough to display all information about a song. Due to its low resolution, video is not a good experience.

An FM player and a Voice recorder are also included, which is good for people who don't like to have too many gadgets.

The ZEN mosaic is a powerful little monster when it comes to music playback. The quality of the bundled headphones are a big let down. You will have to get yourself a good pair of cans if you buy this player, so remember to add that cost.

The battery life is good enough, and lasts about 6



well, but it's still not enough these days. Overall, the bundle is something that looks a lot better than it sounds.

Specifications

Supports MP3, WMA and AVI formats, 1.4 in colour display, loudspeaker, FM radio

Contact: Creative Technology Ltd
Phone: 9352034111
E-mail: nishant_mathur@ctl.creative.com
Web site: http://in.creative.com/
Price: Rs 5,499

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

hours between charges. FM reception is bad, and the lack of an expandable memory slot is worse — you're stuck with the 2 GB provided. There are 4 GB and 8 GB versions available as